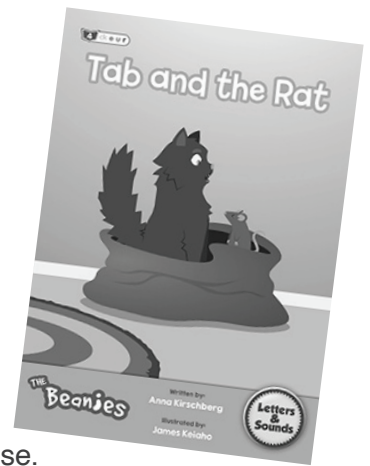




Tab and the Rat

By Anna Kirschberg

Illustrated by James Keiaho



Book Summary

This title looks at a story about a cat named Tab, who encounters a rat in the house. The reader is introduced to new letter sounds. Vivid and detailed illustrations depict and help the text explain some basic information about each page image and create an engaging story.

This book follows the Beanstalk Books (Letters & Sounds) Phase 2 progression and focuses on learning the first 19 letters that are taught in this sequence.

Skills and Strategies

This book builds on decodable reading strategies for high/low readers. The book has been written using a strictly controlled vocabulary. Text uses only **decodable regular words** (according to the week by week progression of Letters & Sounds) along with **'tricky words'** or **'Common Exception Words'** (CEWs). Common Exception Words are frequently used words that are not decodable at this phase.

Phase 2 - Letter Sounds

s	a	t	p	i	n	m	d
g	o	c	k	ck	e	u	r
h	b	f	ff	l	ll	ss	

Tricky Words:

I, the, go, to, no

This book also supports other key reading strategies:

- Recognising the relationship between words and illustrations;
- Pointing one-to-one at each word to ensure an appropriate match;
- Vocabulary and word study.

This book also supports key comprehension strategies:

- Predicting the meanings of new or unfamiliar words from the context of the story;
- Recognising the relationship between letters and their sounds;
- Summarising the main ideas of the story.

Introducing the Text

Open up the discussion about the front cover illustration and make connections with the children's prior knowledge. Prompt discussions by using the vocabulary in the book.

From the title, can you describe what you think the story will be about?

What are the cat and the rat on the front cover doing?

What do you think they are feeling or thinking about?

Read the title and the name of the author to the group. Read aloud any common exception words from the front inner cover.

Reading the Text

Page 2 – Explain where to begin reading, and ask the student to point to each word as you read aloud together. Sound out the letter sounds as you go, for example: (/T/a/b/). On this page, the illustration depicts the cat named Tab.

Page 3 – Sound out the word 'pet' together (/p/e/t/).

Page 4 – This illustration depicts Tab the cat going to take a nap in her sack. She sits in the sack.

Page 6 and 7 – On these pages, Tab encounters a rat is hiding in the sack. Tab chases the rat out of the sack.

Page 8 – On the final page, Tab gets back into the sack for a nap. Discuss. Repeat the words and sound them out several times together.

Students can now read the book independently. At the end of the story, go over the text and illustrations again and discuss what is happening on each page.

Revisiting the Text

As a group, refer back to the table in the front inner cover and identify the words in the story that use the new letter sounds being taught in Phase 2.

To start with, identify as many new consonant and/or vowel graphemes as you can in the words in the text. For example, 's', 'a', 'ck', in the word 'sack'. Sound out the letter sounds to say the word together - /s/a/ck/.

Following Up

Use the BLM for this story, the students can learn more about the introduction of the new letter sounds (Phase 2) being used in the text of the story.